



Chapter 4 Real function

≡ Tags

Courses

▼ Introduction

session: 2/12/2024

Let $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}$. Often, we need to associate to an element $x \in \mathbb{R}$ a value, denoted by $f(x)$. This means that we define a **function** (also called an **application** or **map**).

1. Definition

Let $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}$. A function $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a rule that assigns to every $x \in D$ a unique element $f(x) \in \mathbb{R}$.

- The **range** of f is:

$$\text{range}(f) = \{y \in \mathbb{R} \mid \exists x \in D : y = f(x)\}.$$

We write: $x \rightarrow f(x)$.

- D is called the **domain of definition** of f .
- The set $\{(x, f(x)) \mid x \in D\}$ is called the **graph of f** , usually denoted by $f(D)$.

Remark

If $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ satisfies $f : D \rightarrow f(D)$, then it is called **surjective**.

2. Terminology

- $f(x)$ is called the **image** of x by f .

- x is called the **independent variable** or **argument**.
- $f(x)$ or y (where $f(x) = y$) is called the **dependent variable**.

3. Property

- The **composition** of functions f and g is defined as follows:

$$f \circ g(x) = f(g(x)) \quad \text{and} \quad g \circ f(x) = g(f(x)),$$

provided:

$$\text{range}(g) \subseteq \text{domain}(f) \quad (\text{or} \quad \text{range}(f) \subseteq \text{domain}(g)).$$

- Domains of the compositions are:

$$\text{domain}(f \circ g) = \text{domain}(g), \quad \text{domain}(g \circ f) = \text{domain}(f).$$

1. Addition of Functions

For all $x \in D$:

$$(f + g)(x) = f(x) + g(x).$$

2. Multiplication of Functions

For all $x \in D$:

$$(f \cdot g)(x) = f(x) \cdot g(x).$$

3. Scaling a Function

For all $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ and $x \in D$:

$$(\lambda g)(x) = \lambda \cdot g(x).$$

4. Reciprocal of a Function

If $f(x) \neq 0 \quad \forall x \in D$:

$$\left(\frac{1}{f}\right)(x) = \frac{1}{f(x)}.$$

4. Equality of Functions

Let f and g be two real functions. We say that $f = g$ if and only if:

1. $\text{domain}(f) = \text{domain}(g)$,
2. $f(x) = g(x)$ for all $x \in \text{domain}(f)$.

In general:

$$(f \circ g) \neq (g \circ f).$$

5. Graph of a Function

Let f be a real function. The **graph of f** , denoted by $|f$ or $\text{graph}(f)$, is the set:

$$\text{graph}(f) = \{(x, f(x)) \mid x \in \text{domain}(f)\}.$$

6. Even and Odd Functions

1. The domain of f , D_f , is **symmetric**, meaning:

If $x \in D_f$, then $-x \in D_f$.

- **Even function:** $f(-x) = f(x)$ for all $x \in D_f$.
 - **Odd function:** $f(-x) = -f(x)$ for all $x \in D_f$.
-

7. Periodic Functions

A function $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is called **periodic** if there exists $T > 0$ such that:

1. $x + T \in D$ for all $x \in D$,
2. $f(x + T) = f(x)$ for all $x \in D$.

If f is T -periodic, then for all $x \in D$:

$$f(x + nT) = f(x), \quad n \in \mathbb{Z}.$$

8. Bounded Functions

Definition 4.9

Let $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and let $f(D)$ be the set of all values of f .

- We say that function f is **bounded above** on its domain D if $f(D)$ is bounded above, i.e.,

$$\exists M \in \mathbb{R}, \forall x \in D : f(x) \leq M$$

- We say that function f is **bounded below** on its domain D if $f(D)$ is bounded below, i.e.,

$$\exists m \in \mathbb{R}, \forall x \in D : f(x) \geq m$$
- We say that function f is **bounded** on its domain D if $f(D)$ is bounded, i.e.,

$$\exists A \in \mathbb{R}, \forall x \in D : |f(x)| \leq A$$

Remark 4.3

If f is bounded on D , then $f(D)$ admits a supremum M and an infimum m . We denote:

$$M = \sup_{x \in D} f(x), \quad m = \inf_{x \in D} f(x)$$

We have:

$$\begin{aligned} \sup_{x \in D} f(x) = M < +\infty &\iff \\ \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \forall x \in D, f(x) \leq M \\ \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists x_0 \in D : f(x_0) > M - \epsilon \end{array} \right. & \\ \inf_{x \in D} f(x) = m > -\infty &\iff \\ \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \forall x \in D, f(x) \geq m \\ \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists x_0 \in D : f(x_0) < m + \epsilon \end{array} \right. & \end{aligned}$$

9. Monotone Functions

Definition 4.10

Consider $f : D \subset \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, and set $M \subset D$.

1. f is **nondecreasing** on M if:

$$\forall x_1, x_2 \in M, x_1 \leq x_2 \implies f(x_1) \leq f(x_2)$$

2. f is **nonincreasing** on M if:

$$\forall x_1, x_2 \in M, x_1 \leq x_2 \implies f(x_1) \geq f(x_2)$$

3. f is **increasing** on M if:

$$\forall x_1, x_2 \in M, x_1 < x_2 \implies f(x_1) < f(x_2)$$

4. f is **decreasing** on M if:

$$\forall x_1, x_2 \in M, x_1 < x_2 \implies f(x_1) > f(x_2)$$

A function f that satisfies one of the conditions above is called **monotone**. If f satisfies (1) or (3), it is **monotone**, and if it satisfies (2) or (4), it is **strictly monotone**.

Remark

If f is differentiable, then:

- $f' \geq 0$ implies f is **nondecreasing**.
- $f' > 0$ implies f is **increasing**.
- $f' \leq 0$ implies f is **nonincreasing**.
- $f' < 0$ implies f is **decreasing**.

Remark

The sum of an increasing function and a decreasing function preserves the monotonicity properties.

session: 3/12/2024

10. Injectivity and Monotonicity

We can check if f is **injective** by examining monotonicity. If f is **strictly monotonic**, then f is necessarily **injective** because:

- If $x_1 \neq x_2$, then either $x_1 > x_2$ or $x_2 > x_1$.
- If f is strictly monotonic, then either $f(x_1) < f(x_2)$ or $f(x_1) > f(x_2)$, implying $f(x_1) \neq f(x_2)$.

Thus, f is injective.

11. Inverse Function

Let $f : D \rightarrow R(f)$ be a bijective function. We define the inverse function g as follows:

$$g : R(f) \rightarrow D$$

such that

$$(g \circ f)(x) = x \quad \text{and} \quad (f \circ g)(x) = x$$

Thus, g is the **inverse function** of f and is unique.

Here is your content rewritten with the correct formatting for mathematical symbols using double dollar signs:

Inverse Image Properties

1. Unions:

$$f^{-1} \left[\bigcup_{i \in I} U_i \right] = \bigcup_{i \in I} f^{-1}(U_i)$$

2. Intersections:

$$f^{-1} \left[\bigcap_{i \in I} U_i \right] = \bigcap_{i \in I} f^{-1}(U_i)$$

3. Complements:

$$f^{-1}(U^c) = (f^{-1}(U))^c$$

4. Set Differences:

$$f^{-1}(U \setminus V) = f^{-1}(U) \setminus f^{-1}(V)$$

5. Symmetric Differences:

$$f^{-1}(U \Delta V) = f^{-1}(U) \Delta f^{-1}(V)$$

Miscellaneous Identities for Inverse Image:

$$1. f|_X^{-1}(Y) = X \cap f^{-1}(Y)$$

$$2. f(f^{-1}(Y)) = Y \cap f(A)$$

$$3. X \subset f^{-1}(f(X)), \text{ with equality if } f \text{ is injective.}$$

Direct Image Properties

Let $(f : A \rightarrow B)$ be a function and $(U \subset A)$.

1. Unions:

$$f \left[\bigcup_{i \in I} U_i \right] = \bigcup_{i \in I} f(U_i)$$

2. Intersections:

$$f \left[\bigcap_{i \in I} U_i \right] \subset \bigcap_{i \in I} f(U_i)$$

3. Set Difference:

$$f(V \setminus U) \supset f(V) \setminus f(U)$$

In particular, the complement of $(U \setminus)$ satisfies:

$$f(U^c) \supset f(A) \setminus f(U)$$

4. Subsets:

If $(U \setminus \subset V \setminus \subset A \setminus)$, then:

$$f(U) \subset f(V) \subset B$$

5. Inverse Image of a Direct Image:

$$f^{-1}(f(U)) \supset U$$

with equality if (f) is injective.

6. Direct Image of an Inverse Image:

$$f[f^{-1}(V)] \subset V$$

Remark

We search for g by solving the equation $y = f(x)$ and finding $x = g(y)$.

If f is increasing and bijective on the interval $[\frac{\pi}{2}, -\frac{\pi}{2}]$, then f admits an inverse map denoted by $f^{-1} = \arcsin$, and we have:

$$\arcsin(\sin(x)) = x \quad \text{for } x \in \left[-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}\right]$$

The inverse is defined by:

$$\sin(\arcsin(x)) = x \quad \text{for } -1 \leq x \leq 1$$

12. Inverse Image

Let $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function that is not necessarily bijective. We define the **inverse image** of a set $B \subset \mathbb{R}$ as:

$$f^{-1}(B) = \{x \in D : f(x) \in B\}$$

For example,

$$f^{-1}(\{0, 1, 2, 3\}) = \{0, 1, -1, \sqrt{3}, -\sqrt{3}, -2, 2\}$$

Theorem on Pre-images of Unions and Intersections

Let f be a real function, $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, and let U be a subset of $\mathbb{R}$.

session: 9/12/2024

Let $F(D, R)$ denote the set of all functions defined on D with their range included in R . The set $F(D, R)$ is a **vectorial space**.

Properties of Functions

1. A function f is said to be **nonnegative** if:

$$\forall x \in D, f(x) \geq 0.$$

2. A function f is said to be **positive** if:

$$\forall x \in D, f(x) > 0.$$

3. A function f is said to be **negative** if:

$$\forall x \in D, f(x) < 0.$$

4. We say $f \leq g$ if:

$$\forall x \in D, f(x) \leq g(x).$$

Remark

The space $F(D, R)$ is not totally ordered.

▼ Limits of Functions

Let f be a function defined on D , and let x_0 be an accumulation point of D (not necessarily belonging to D). We say that f converges to a real number l as $x \rightarrow x_0$ if:

■

Notation

- $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = l$
means the limit of $f(x)$ as $x \rightarrow x_0$ is l .
- $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^+} f(x) = l$
represents the limit of $f(x)$ as x approaches x_0 from the right-hand side.
- Similarly, $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^-} f(x) = l$
represents the left-hand limit.



Theorem: Uniqueness of Limits

If a limit exists, it is unique.

▼ Proof

Suppose $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = l_1$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = l_2$. Then:

$$0 < |l_1 - l_2| = |l_1 - f(x) + f(x) - l_2| \leq |f(x) - l_1| + |f(x) - l_2|.$$

Given the definitions of limits, this leads to a contradiction unless $l_1 = l_2$.

2. Limits at Infinity

- $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = +\infty$ if:
$$\forall B > 0, \exists \delta > 0 \text{ such that } 0 < |x - x_0| < \delta \implies f(x) > B.$$
- $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = -\infty$ if:
$$\forall B > 0, \exists \delta > 0 \text{ such that } 0 < |x - x_0| < \delta \implies f(x) < -B.$$
- $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x) = l$ if:
$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists A > 0 \text{ such that } x < -A \implies |f(x) - l| < \epsilon.$$
- $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = l$ if:

$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists A > 0$ such that $x > A \implies |f(x) - l| < \epsilon$.

- $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = +\infty$ if:

$\forall B > 0, \exists A > 0$ such that $x > A \implies f(x) > B$.

- $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x) = -\infty$ if:

$\forall B > 0, \exists A > 0$ such that $x < -A \implies f(x) < -B$.

- $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x) = +\infty$ if and only if:

$\forall B > 0, \exists A > 0$ such that $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, x < -A \implies f(x) > B$.

- $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x) = -\infty$ if and only if:

$\forall B > 0, \exists A > 0$ such that $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, x < -A \implies f(x) < -B$.

3. Main Theorems



Sequential Characterization of Limits

Let f be a function defined on D , and let x_0 be an accumulation point of D . Then the following are equivalent:

1. $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = l$.
2. For all sequences $(x_n) \subset D$ such that $x_n \rightarrow x_0$, we have $f(x_n) \rightarrow l$.

▼ Proof

- **(1) $\Rightarrow$ (2):**

Suppose $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = l$. Then, for any sequence (x_n) converging to x_0 :

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta > 0 \text{ such that } |x - x_0| \leq \delta \implies |f(x) - l| \leq \epsilon.$$

Hence,

$$|f(x_n) - l| \leq \epsilon \text{ for sufficiently large } n.$$

- **(2) $\Rightarrow$ (1):**

Suppose $\lim_{x_n \rightarrow x_0} f(x_n) = l$ for every sequence (x_n) , but $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) \neq l$. Then there exists $\epsilon > 0$ such that:

$$\forall \delta > 0, \exists x \text{ with } |x - x_0| \leq \delta \text{ and } |f(x) - l| > \epsilon.$$

Construct a sequence

(x_n) converging to x_0 that violates the sequential limit, leading to a contradiction.

4. Limit Algebra Rules

Let f and g be functions defined on the same domain D , and let x_0 be an accumulation point. If:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = l_1 \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x) = l_2,$$

then:

1. $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (f(x) + g(x)) = l_1 + l_2.$
2. $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (f(x) \cdot g(x)) = l_1 \cdot l_2.$
3. $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (\alpha \cdot f(x)) = \alpha \cdot l_1 \quad (\alpha \in \mathbb{R}).$
4. $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} |f(x)| = |l_1|.$
5. $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} = \frac{l_1}{l_2}, \quad \text{if } l_2 \neq 0.$

proof

Like sequences



Theorem

Let f and g be functions defined on D , and suppose:

$$\forall x \in D, f(x) \leq g(x).$$

Then:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) \leq \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x).$$

12/10/2024

Corollary 4.2

Let $f : D \subset \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function, and let x_0 be an accumulation point of D . Suppose that $M_1 < f(x) < M_2$ for all $x \in D$, and suppose that:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = L$$

Then:

$$M_1 \leq L \leq M_2$$

Proof: احشتم (This proof is considered trivial or straightforward.)

Corollary 4.3

Let $f : D \subset \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function, and let x_0 be an accumulation point of D . If:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = l \in \mathbb{R}$$

then:

$\exists \delta > 0$ such that for $0 < |x - x_0| < \delta$, $f(x)$ is bounded.

Proof:

By the definition of a limit, we have:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta > 0 \text{ such that } 0 < |x - x_0| < \delta \implies |f(x) - l| < \epsilon$$

Therefore:

$$l - \epsilon \leq f(x) \leq l + \epsilon$$

This implies that $f(x)$ is bounded within the interval $[x_0 - \delta, x_0 + \delta]$.



Theorem

Let $f, g : D \subset \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be functions, and let x_0 be an accumulation point of D . If:

- g is bounded on D , and
- $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = 0$,

then:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x)g(x) = 0$$

▼ Proof:

Using the **squeeze theorem**:

- Since $f(x) \rightarrow 0$ as $x \rightarrow x_0$, for any $\epsilon > 0$, there exists $\delta > 0$ such that:

$$|f(x)| < \frac{\epsilon}{M}, \quad \forall x \text{ where } 0 < |x - x_0| < \delta$$

where M is the bound of $|g(x)|$, i.e., $|g(x)| \leq M$ for all $x \in D$.

- Then:

$$|f(x)g(x)| \leq |f(x)| \cdot M < \frac{\epsilon}{M} \cdot M = \epsilon$$

Thus:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x)g(x) = 0$$

Corollary

Suppose that:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = L, \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x) = M$$

and x_0 is a point of accumulation of $D_f \cap D_g$. Then:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \max\{f(x), g(x)\} = \max\{L, M\}$$

and:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \min\{f(x), g(x)\} = \min\{L, M\}$$

Proof:

The first result follows from the identity:

$$\max\{a, b\} = \frac{a+b}{2} + \frac{|a-b|}{2}$$

$$\max\{f(x), g(x)\} = \frac{f(x)+g(x)}{2} + \frac{|f(x)-g(x)|}{2}$$

By the theorem on limits of sums and limits of absolute values, we can take the limit as $x \rightarrow x_0$:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \max\{f(x), g(x)\} = \frac{L+M}{2} + \frac{|L-M|}{2} = \max\{L, M\}$$

Similarly, for the minimum:

$$\min\{f(x), g(x)\} = \frac{f(x)+g(x)}{2} - \frac{|f(x)-g(x)|}{2}$$

Taking the limit as $x \rightarrow x_0$:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \min\{f(x), g(x)\} = \frac{L+M}{2} - \frac{|L-M|}{2} = \min\{L, M\}$$

▼ Continuous Functions

Definition:

Let $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, and let $x_0 \in D$. We say that f is continuous at x_0 if:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta = \delta(\epsilon) > 0, \forall x \in D : (0 < |x - x_0| < \delta) \implies |f(x) - f(x_0)| < \epsilon$$

We denote this by:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = f(x_0)$$

Continuity from the left:

A function f is said to be continuous from the left at x_0 if:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^-} f(x) = f(x_0)$$

Continuity from the right:

A function f is said to be continuous from the right at x_0 if:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^+} f(x) = f(x_0)$$

Example:

Consider the function:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{\sin(x)}{x}, & x \neq 0 \\ b, & x = 0 \end{cases}$$

We calculate:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^-} f(x) = 1, \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} f(x) = 1$$

If $b = 1$, then f is continuous at $x_0 = 0$.

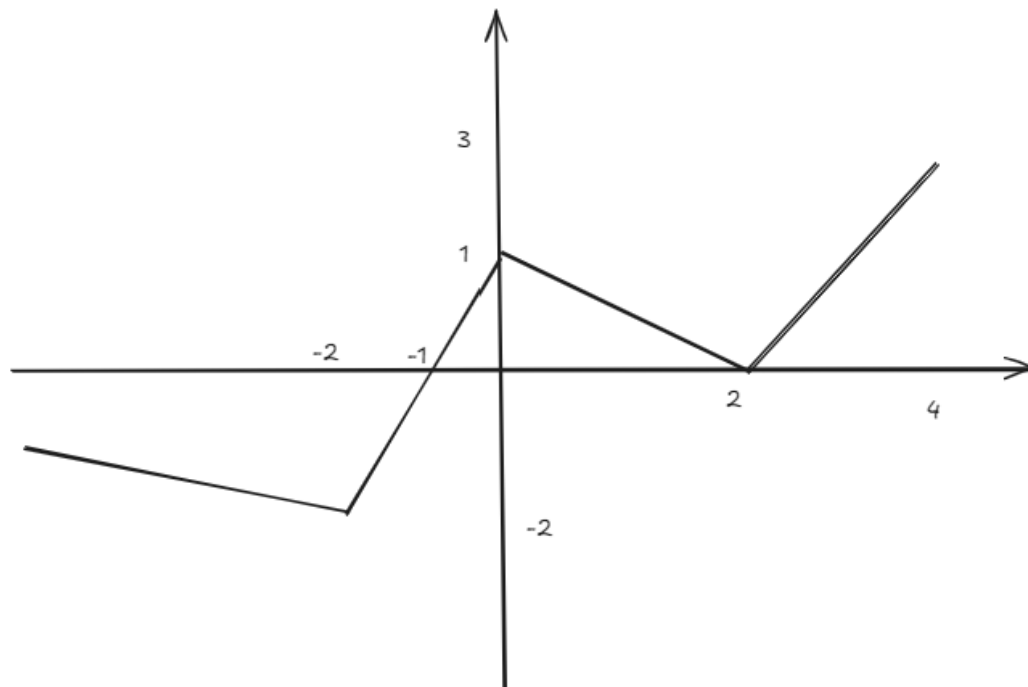
Definition for closed intervals:

A function f defined on a closed interval $[a, b]$ is said to be continuous:

- For all $x \in]a, b[$, it is continuous.
- At $x_0 = a$, it is right-continuous.
- At $x_0 = b$, it is left-continuous.

Example:

The function $f(x) = \sqrt{1 - x^2}$ is continuous on $[-1, 1]$.

**▼ 1. Types of Discontinuities****Definition:**

A function f is said to be discontinuous at x_0 if it is not continuous at x_0 .

Types of Discontinuities:**1. Removable Discontinuities:**

This occurs when:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^-} f(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^+} f(x) = L$$

but $f(x_0)$ is either undefined or not equal to L .

The discontinuity can be "removed" by redefining:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} f(x), & x \neq x_0 \\ L, & x = x_0 \end{cases}$$

Example:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{\sin(x)}{x}, & x \neq 0 \\ 1, & x = 0 \end{cases}$$

Here, $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^-} f(x) = 1$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} f(x) = 1$, so the discontinuity is removable.

2. Discontinuity of the First Kind:

A function f has a discontinuity of the first kind at x_0 if:

$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^-} f(x)$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^+} f(x)$ both exist but are not equal.

Example:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{|x|}{x}, & x \neq 0 \\ 5, & x = 0 \end{cases}$$

3. Discontinuity of the Second Kind:

A function f has a discontinuity of the second kind at x_0 if either:

$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^-} f(x)$ or $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^+} f(x)$ does not exist.

Example: Consider a step function that jumps infinitely near x_0 .

Theorems

**Theorem 1:**

Let $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function, and let $x_0 \in D$. The following statements are equivalent:

1. f is continuous at x_0 .
2. For any sequence $(x_n) \in D$ such that $x_n \rightarrow x_0$, we have:

$$f(x_n) \rightarrow f(x_0)$$

▼ Proof:

Assume f is continuous at x_0 . Take $l = f(x_0)$. Then, for all $\epsilon > 0$, there exists $\delta > 0$ such that:

$$|x - x_0| < \delta \implies |f(x) - f(x_0)| < \epsilon$$

Thus, continuity implies the sequential property.

**Theorem 2 (Algebra of Continuous Functions):**

If f and g are continuous at x_0 , then:

1. $f + g$ is continuous at x_0 .
2. $f - g$ is continuous at x_0 .
3. fg is continuous at x_0 .
4. If $g(x_0) \neq 0$, then $\frac{f}{g}$ is continuous at x_0 .

**Theorem 3:**

If f is continuous on $[a, b]$, then f is bounded.

Proof (By Contradiction):

Assume f is not bounded on $[a, b]$. Then for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, there exists $x_n \in [a, b]$ such that:

$$f(x_n) \geq n$$

The sequence (x_n) is bounded, so by the Bolzano-Weierstrass theorem, there exists a subsequence (x_{n_k}) that converges to some $\xi \in [a, b]$.

By continuity:

$$f(x_{n_k}) \rightarrow f(\xi)$$

But this contradicts $f(x_{n_k}) \rightarrow +\infty$. Hence, f must be bounded.



Theorem: Boundedness and Attainment of Extrema

If a function f is continuous on a closed interval $[a, b]$, then it attains its bounds at least once in $[a, b]$.

▼ Proof

1. Case: Constant Function

If f is a constant function, then it attains its bounds at every point of the interval.

2. Case: Non-Constant Function

Let f be a function that is not constant. Since f is continuous on the closed interval $[a, b]$, it is bounded.

Let m and M be the infimum and supremum of f , respectively.

We need to show that $\exists \alpha, \beta \in [a, b]$ such that:

$$f(\alpha) = m \quad \text{and} \quad f(\beta) = M.$$

3. Consider the Supremum M

Suppose f does not attain the supremum M , so that:

$$f(x) \neq M \quad \forall x \in [a, b].$$

Define the function:

$$g(x) = \frac{1}{M - f(x)}, \quad \forall x \in [a, b].$$

This function is positive for all $x \in [a, b]$.

4. Properties of $g(x)$

Since f is continuous and $M - f(x) > 0$ for all x , $g(x)$ is also continuous and bounded on $[a, b]$.

Let $k > 0$ be the supremum of $g(x)$. Then:

$$\frac{1}{M - f(x)} \leq k, \quad \forall x \in [a, b].$$

This implies:

$$f(x) \leq M - \frac{1}{k}, \quad \forall x \in [a, b].$$

This is a contradiction, as M was assumed to be the supremum. Hence, f must attain the value M .

By a similar argument, f attains the infimum m .



Theorem: Continuity and Local Sign Preservation

If a function f is continuous at an interior point c of an interval $[a, b]$ and $f(c) \neq 0$, then there exists a neighborhood N of c where $f(x)$ has the same sign as $f(c)$ for all $x \in N$

▼ Proof

By the definition of continuity, for any $\epsilon > 0$, there exists $\delta = \delta(\epsilon) > 0$ such that:

$$0 < |x - c| < \delta \implies |f(x) - f(c)| < \epsilon.$$

1. Case: $f(c) > 0$

Choose $\epsilon = \frac{f(c)}{2} > 0$. Then for $x \in (c - \delta, c + \delta)$:

$$f(c) - \epsilon < f(x) < f(c) + \epsilon.$$

Substituting $\epsilon = \frac{f(c)}{2}$:

$$\frac{f(c)}{2} < f(x) < \frac{3f(c)}{2}.$$

Thus, $f(x) > 0$ in this neighborhood.

2. Case: $f(c) < 0$

Choose $\epsilon = -\frac{f(c)}{3} > 0$. Then for $x \in (c - \delta, c + \delta)$:

$$f(c) - \epsilon < f(x) < f(c) + \epsilon.$$

Substituting $\epsilon = -\frac{f(c)}{3}$:

$$\frac{2f(c)}{3} < f(x) < \frac{f(c)}{3}.$$

Thus, $f(x) < 0$ in this neighborhood.



Theorem: Intermediate Value Theorem (IVT)

Let f be a continuous function on $[a, b]$.

If $f(a) \cdot f(b) < 0$, then $\exists \alpha \in]a, b[$ such that $f(\alpha) = 0$.

▼ Proof

1. Case: $f(a) > 0$ and $f(b) < 0$

Define the set:

$$S = \{x \in [a, b] : f(x) > 0\}.$$

- Since $f(a) > 0$, we have $a \in S$, so $S \neq \emptyset$.
- The set S is bounded, as $S \subseteq [a, b]$.

2. Existence of Supremum

By the completeness property of real numbers, the supremum of S exists. Let:

$$\alpha = \sup S.$$

3. Case: $\alpha \neq a$

Since $\alpha = \sup S$ and f is continuous at α :

- For any $\gamma > 0$, $\forall x \in [a, a + \gamma]$, we have $f(x) > 0$.
- This would imply $a + \gamma \in S$, contradicting $\alpha = \sup S$.

Therefore,

$$\alpha \neq a.$$

4. Case: $\alpha \neq b$

Since $f(b) < 0$ and f is continuous at b :

- There exists $\beta > 0$ such that $\forall x \in [b - \beta, b]$, $f(x) < 0$.
- However, this would imply that $b - \beta$ is an upper bound of S , contradicting $\alpha = \sup S$.

Therefore,

$$\alpha \neq b.$$

Conclusion

Thus, $\alpha \in]a, b[$, and by the continuity of f at α :

$$f(\alpha) = 0.$$

Let $\alpha = \sup S$, where $S = \{x \in [a, b] : f(x) > 0\}$. The following properties hold:

1. $\forall x \in S : x \leq \alpha$.
2. $\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists x_\epsilon \in S : \alpha - \epsilon < x_\epsilon \leq \alpha$.
3. Specifically, for $\epsilon = \frac{1}{n}, \forall n \in \mathbb{N}$:
 - $n = 1 \implies x_1 \in S : \alpha - 1 < x_1 \leq \alpha$,
 - $n = 2 \implies x_2 \in S : \alpha - \frac{1}{2} < x_2 \leq \alpha$,
 - $n \implies x_n \in S : \alpha - \frac{1}{n} < x_n \leq \alpha$.

Proof by Contradiction

Let $x_n \in S$ be a sequence where $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} x_n = \alpha$.

Since $f(x) > 0$ for all $x \in S$ and f is continuous at α , we have:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = f(\alpha).$$

Thus, $f(\alpha) > 0$.

However:

1. $\alpha \in]a, b[$, and f is continuous at α .
2. By continuity, $\exists \delta > 0$ such that $\forall x \in [\alpha - \delta, \alpha + \delta], f(x) > 0$.
3. This implies $\alpha + \delta$ is an upper bound of S , contradicting $\alpha = \sup S$.

Therefore, $f(\alpha) = 0$ must hold.

▼ 2. Applications

1. Example: Function with Discontinuity

Define the function:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{x}, & x \neq 0 \\ 0, & x = 0 \end{cases}.$$

This function is not continuous at $x = 0$. However, $f(x)$ demonstrates the idea of attaining bounds for continuous functions.

2. Example: Trigonometric Function with a Root

Define

$$k(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{\sin(x-1)}{x-2}, & x \neq 2 \\ 0, & x = 2 \end{cases}.$$

Here, $\exists \alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ such that $f(\alpha) = 0$. For example:

$$k(1) = 0.$$

Corollary

Let $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a continuous function. Then f assumes any value between its extrema.

Proof

1. Consider a subinterval $[a, \beta] \subseteq [a, b]$.
 - Let $M = \sup_{a \leq x \leq \beta} f(x)$.
 - Let $m = \inf_{a \leq x \leq \beta} f(x)$.
2. By the Intermediate Value Theorem, f attains every value in $[m, M]$.



Theorem: Intermediate Value Theorem (Generalized Form)

Let $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a continuous function.

If $f(a) \neq f(b)$, then $\forall A \in [f(a), f(b)], \exists c \in]a, b[: f(c) = A$.

▼ Proof

1. Define the auxiliary function:

$$\phi(x) = f(x) - A,$$

where $\phi : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$.

2. **Properties of $\phi(x)$:**

- ϕ is continuous because f is continuous.
- At the endpoints:

$$\phi(a) = f(a) - A, \quad \phi(b) = f(b) - A.$$

3. If $\phi(a) \cdot \phi(b) < 0$, by the Intermediate Value Theorem, there exists $c \in]a, b[$ such that:

$$\phi(c) = 0.$$

4. Substituting $\phi(c) = 0$ into the definition of ϕ :

$$f(c) - A = 0 \implies f(c) = A.$$

Thus, $\forall A \in [f(a), f(b)],$ there exists $c \in]a, b[$ such that $f(c) = A$.

▼ 3. Uniform Continuity

Let $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a function. We say that f is **uniformly continuous** on D if:

$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta = \delta(\epsilon) > 0$ such that $\forall x, y \in D,$

$$|x - y| \leq \delta \implies |f(x) - f(y)| \leq \epsilon.$$

Examples of Uniform Continuity

Example 1: Function $f(x) = x^2$

Let:

- $D_1 = [1, 17]$ (closed interval),
- $D_2 =]-5, 4[$ (open interval).

Uniform Continuity on D_1

The function $f(x)$ is **uniformly continuous** on D_1 if:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \gamma(\epsilon) > 0, \forall x, y \in D_1, |x - y| \leq \gamma \implies |f(x) - f(y)| \leq \epsilon.$$

Let $\epsilon > 0$. We calculate:

$$|f(x) - f(y)| = |x^2 - y^2| = |x - y||x + y|.$$

On the interval D_1 , the maximum value of $|x + y|$ occurs when $x, y = 17$:

$$|x + y| \leq 34.$$

Thus:

$$|f(x) - f(y)| \leq 34|x - y|.$$

To ensure $|f(x) - f(y)| \leq \epsilon$, choose:

$$\gamma = \frac{\epsilon}{34}.$$

Hence, $f(x) = x^2$ is uniformly continuous on D_1 .

Example 2: Function $f(x) = x^2$ on $\mathbb{R}$

For $D = \mathbb{R}$, the function $f(x) = x^2$ is **not uniformly continuous**. Proof by counterexample:

Let $\epsilon = 1$. For any $\delta > 0$, we can choose:

$$x_n = n + \frac{1}{n}, \quad y_n = n - \frac{1}{n},$$

where $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Then:

1. $|x_n - y_n| = \frac{2}{n}$, which can be made smaller than any $\delta > 0$ for sufficiently large n .

As $n \rightarrow \infty$, $|f(x_n) - f(y_n)|$ becomes arbitrarily large, violating uniform continuity.

Thus, $f(x) = x^2$ is not uniformly continuous on $\mathbb{R}$.

Example 3: Function $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$ on $[0, +\infty[$

The function $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$ is continuous on $[0, +\infty[$.

To verify **uniform continuity**, for any $\epsilon > 0$, let:

$$|f(x) - f(y)| = |\sqrt{x} - \sqrt{y}|.$$

By the Mean Value Theorem for square roots:

$$|\sqrt{x} - \sqrt{y}| = \frac{|x-y|}{\sqrt{c}},$$

A function ρ_3 is **uniformly continuous** on a set if:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta(\epsilon) > 0 : \forall x, y \in [0, +\infty[, |x - y| \leq \delta \implies |\sqrt{x} - \sqrt{y}| \leq \epsilon$$

Proof

1. Start with:

$$|\sqrt{x} - \sqrt{y}| = \frac{|x-y|}{\sqrt{x} + \sqrt{y}}$$

2. For any $x, y \geq 0$:

$$\frac{|x-y|}{\sqrt{x} + \sqrt{y}} \leq \frac{|x-y|}{2\sqrt{a}}$$

where

$$a = \min(x, y) \text{ and } \sqrt{x} + \sqrt{y} \geq 2\sqrt{a}$$

Thus, $|\sqrt{x} - \sqrt{y}| \leq \frac{|x-y|}{2\sqrt{a}}$, ensuring uniform continuity.

Function Analysis

Example: $f(x) = \frac{\sin x}{x}$, $D = [0, 3]$

- Define:

$$\tilde{f}(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{\sin x}{x}, & x \in (0, 3] \\ 1, & x = 0 \end{cases}$$

- Continuity:

$\tilde{f}(x)$ is continuous on $[0, 3]$ because the limit as $x \rightarrow 0$ matches the value at $x = 0$:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sin x}{x} = 1.$$

Example: $f(x) = \sin(x^2)$, $D = \mathbb{R}$

- **Not uniformly continuous:**

- Sequence:

$$x_n = \sqrt{2n\pi}, \quad y_n = \sqrt{2n\pi} + \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{n\pi}.$$

- Difference:

$$|f(x_n) - f(y_n)| > \epsilon \text{ for arbitrarily small } |x_n - y_n|.$$



Theorem: Uniform Continuity of Continuous Functions

Let $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a continuous function on the closed interval $[a, b]$. Then, f is uniformly continuous on $[a, b]$.

▼ Proof by Contradiction:

Assume f is **not uniformly continuous**. Then:

$$\exists \epsilon > 0, \forall \delta > 0, \exists x, y \in [a, b] : |x - y| \leq \delta \text{ and } |f(x) - f(y)| > \epsilon.$$

This means we can construct sequences $\{x_n\}$ and $\{y_n\}$ such that:

1. $x_n, y_n \in [a, b]$,
2. $|x_n - y_n| \leq \frac{1}{n}$,
3. $|f(x_n) - f(y_n)| > \epsilon$.

Compactness of $[a, b]$:

- Since $[a, b]$ is compact, the sequences $\{x_n\}$ and $\{y_n\}$ are bounded.
- By the Bolzano-Weierstrass theorem, there exist subsequences $\{x_{n_k}\}$ and $\{y_{n_k}\}$ that converge to some point $c \in [a, b]$:

$$x_{n_k} \rightarrow c, \quad y_{n_k} \rightarrow c.$$

